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# About MariaDB Server - MariaDB.org

# About MariaDB Server

MariaDB Server is one of the most popular database servers in the world. It’s made by the original developers of MySQL and guaranteed to stay open source. Notable users include Wikipedia, WordPress.com and Google.

MariaDB Server turns data into structured information in a wide array of applications, ranging from banking to websites. Originally designed as enhanced, drop-in replacement for MySQL, MariaDB Server is used because it is fast, scalable and robust, with a rich ecosystem of storage engines, plugins and many other tools make it very versatile for a wide variety of use cases.

MariaDB Server is developed as open source software and as a relational database it provides an SQL interface for accessing data. The latest versions of MariaDB Server also include GIS and JSON features.

More information can be found in the MariaDB Server Documentation, for example:

MariaDB Server vs. MySQL – Features
MariaDB Server vs. MySQL – Compatibility

There is also a good Wikipedia article about MariaDB Server and the MySQL history.

MariaDB Server will remain Free and Open Source Software licensed under GPLv2, independent of any commercial entities.

## MariaDB Server in brief

- MariaDB Server in brief (English)
- MariaDB Server in Kürze (German)
- MariaDB Server en resumen (Spanish)
- MariaDB Server 简介 (Chinese)
- MariaDB Server en bref (French)
- MariaDB Server pe scurt (Romanian)

## About MariaDB Foundation

The cornerstones of the MariaDB Foundation mission are Openness, Adoption, and Continuity.

- We ensure the MariaDB Server code base remains open for usage and contributions on technical merits.
- We strive to increase adoption by users and across use cases, platforms and means of deployment.
- We provide continuity to the MariaDB Server ecosystem, independent of any commercial entities.

The MariaDB Foundation is the global contact point for collaboration on MariaDB Server.

The Foundation is non-profit incorporated in Delaware, USA. and is funded by corporate and individual sponsors.

The Foundation's staff supports MariaDB Server by:

- Encouraging adoption, contribution and distribution of MariaDB Server and related open source software.
- Helping new contributors understand the source code and lowering the barrier for new participants.
- Participating in the design of new features, ensuring the code quality and maintainability of the codebase while the number of contributors is growing.
- Making sure documentation keeps up with the development of new features.
- Porting and packaging MariaDB Server to different platforms and operating systems to keep it as widely available as possible.
- Speaking at events and driving adoption.

Details about the Foundation's principles, operation and the board of directors are available on the Governance Overview page sourced from the MariaDB/governance repository. More information regarding board meeting minutes can be found here.

While the Foundation's staff do work on the code base and develop MariaDB Server to some extent, the mission of the Foundation is not to develop MariaDB Server as much as possible, but to empower a large as possible community to be successful in collaborative MariaDB Server development.

## Benefactors

### Sponsors

The MariaDB Foundation is grateful to the following organizations for their substantial support:

#### Diamond sponsors

Amazon is an American multinational technology company headquartered in Seattle, Washington, founded in 1994. Originally launched as an online bookstore, it has evolved into the world's largest online retailer and a dominant force in cloud computing (via Amazon Web Services), digital streaming, and artificial intelligence.

DBS is a leading financial services group in Asia, with over 280 branches across 18 markets. Headquartered and listed in Singapore, DBS has a growing presence in the three key Asian axes of growth: Greater China, Southeast Asia and South Asia. The bank's capital position, as well as "AA-" and "Aa1" credit ratings, is among the highest in Asia-Pacific.

MariaDB Corporation, Founding Member of MariaDB Foundation, is the Primary Code Contributor to MariaDB Server. They provide products and services around MariaDB Server. MariaDB Corporation has the largest number of MariaDB experts and contributors. MariaDB provides subscription services and downloads with additional enterprise features.

**Platinum sponsors**

IBM is a global technology company with over a century of history, providing hardware, software, and services to enterprises worldwide. Among its flagship offerings are the IBM Power and IBM Z server lines — platforms engineered for the most demanding enterprise workloads, where reliability, security, and performance are non-negotiable.

**Gold Sponsors**

Aqtra is a Development Infrastructure Layer (DIL) platform for building ERP solutions, business applications, internal and external portals, and workflows that connect multiple systems. The platform provides the underlying architecture, governance, integration, and runtime capabilities required to develop and operate business applications at scale, helping organisations automate complex processes without building and maintaining every application from scratch.

Hetzner was founded 1997 and is one of Europe's biggest web hosting companies. We offer dedicated servers, cloud solutions, web hosting, storage products and much more – at unbelievably low prices.

IONOS is the leading European digitalization partner for small and medium-sized businesses (SMB). The company serves around six million customers and operates across 18 markets in Europe and North America, with its services being accessible worldwide. With its Web Presence & Productivity portfolio, IONOS acts as a 'one-stop shop' for all digitalization needs: from domains and web hosting to classic website builders and do-it-yourself solutions, from e-commerce to online marketing tools. In addition, the company offers Cloud Solutions to enterprises who are looking to move to the cloud as their businesses evolve.

ScalaHosting is a US-based provider of fully managed cloud VPS hosting, serving businesses, agencies, and developers worldwide. MariaDB runs as the default database across its managed fleet, administered through SPanel – ScalaHosting's own all-in-one control panel, developed in-house and included with every managed plan as an alternative to cPanel. Because ScalaHosting develops and maintains its own control panel, database management sits directly within its platform rather than in third-party software. This allows the company to keep MariaDB versions current across its infrastructure and to build database management, monitoring, and upgrade tooling for customers who depend on MariaDB in production without employing a dedicated database administrator. For most of these customers, the database is never chosen explicitly – it arrives as part of the hosting platform. Managed hosting providers therefore play a significant role in MariaDB adoption, and ScalaHosting's sponsorship reflects a commitment to keeping that foundation open, current, and well maintained.

Scarf pioneered the field of open source usage analytics and continues to lead it today. By helping open source projects understand how they're adopted and used by businesses, governments, and developers around the world, Scarf empowers maintainers to drive sustainability and impact. Processing billions of open source downloads daily, Scarf delivers actionable insights, while championing privacy and transparency for users.

**Silver Sponsors**

Amazic connects innovative software vendors with partners, developers and organisations looking to adopt modern technologies. Combining software distribution with technical enablement, training, content and community-focused events, Amazic helps bridge the gap between technology innovation and real-world adoption. MariaDB Enterprise is already part of Amazic's software portfolio, making its support for the MariaDB Foundation a natural extension of its involvement in the MariaDB ecosystem.

Born out of 15 years of experience in architecture and databases and driven by a commitment to prioritize clients' interests, ArbauDie.IT is an information technology and services company based in France, operating worldwide. It focuses its services on data, from infrastructure to apps through audits, workshops and training on MariaDB and MySQL technologies.

Auree is building a cloud-independent platform for deploying and operating highly available open source databases, including MariaDB, inside customers' own cloud accounts. Its Bring Your Own Cloud model allows organisations to choose their cloud provider, region, infrastructure size, and security environment while Auree automates database provisioning, monitoring, backups, clustering, and failover.

Automattic – distributed company behind WordPress.com, WooCommerce, Jetpack, Simplenote, Longreads, VaultPress, Akismet, Gravatar, Crowdsignal, Cloudup, Tumblr, and more.

Continuent develops solutions for organizations running business-critical applications on MariaDB and other MySQL-compatible databases. Its flagship product, Tungsten Cluster, helps organizations manage database availability, disaster recovery and distributed deployments across on-premises, cloud and hybrid environments.

Crest Infosolutions Headquartered in Malaysia, today we operate in countries like Singapore, Hong Kong, Thailand, India and Philippines. We have been delivering high quality, scalable and cost-effective Digital Transformation solutions to a global clientele since 2012 with great professionalism, proven skills and recognized expertise to bring ease of technology to our clients with best ROI to them in time.

Datography focuses on helping organizations understand, map, and manage complex data environments. As data infrastructures grow increasingly distributed across platforms, services, and geographies, having clear visibility into how data flows and where it resides becomes critical for governance, security, and operational efficiency.

DBaasNow is a database operations control plane that automates provisioning, upgrades, scaling, and high availability across cloud, on-premises, and hybrid environments. It enables zero-downtime operations while running entirely within the customer environment, with no vendor lock-in.

DbVisualizer is a leading cross-platform database client designed to simplify database management and development. Trusted by developers and DBAs around the world, it offers powerful tools for querying, visualizing, and optimizing data across all major databases – with dedicated support for MariaDB.

Diegesis is a UK-based tech consultancy supporting organisations looking to develop, integrate, or migrate legacy systems to the latest technology frameworks. We work with clients in both the private and public sector to deliver innovative solutions to complex problems, with our decades of experience shared amongst a talented and committed staff. We have 30 years' experience in data management across both public and private sectors. With a breadth of knowledge and experience to hand, we secure the best outcomes in legacy systems transformation. Our experienced consulting team gets results with a focus on delivering robust and sustainable solutions. We combine established expertise in Ingres, Notes, COBOL and TUXEDO with the latest practices in Amazon AWS, Microsoft Azure and Google GCP cloud platforms.

Elestio is a managed DevOps platform for open source software. It deploys and operates 400+ tools, including MariaDB, on dedicated virtual machines across 9 cloud providers and 160+ regions, on the cloud of your choice, your own VMs or on premise. Installation, configuration, encryption, backups, monitoring, OS and software updates are all handled by Elestio. Founded in 2022 and headquartered in Dublin, Ireland. SOC 2 Type II, ISO 27001:2022, GDPR and HIPAA compliant.

Epsio – Transform heavy and slow batch SQL queries into fast & efficient streaming transformations using the SQL you already know in the database you already have.

Frappe builds open-source software for running organisations, including ERPNext, Frappe HR and Frappe CRM. Its applications are built on Frappe Framework, where MariaDB is the default database. That makes MariaDB part of the infrastructure behind the work Frappe users do every day, from managing finances and inventory to serving customers.

HammerDB: The industry standard open-source database benchmark.

Kamatera provides scalable cloud servers and infrastructure across a worldwide network of data centres, giving developers and organisations control over where and how they run their applications. That flexibility makes it a natural environment for open-source technologies such as MariaDB, which users can deploy, configure and scale according to their own technical and geographic requirements.

Mydbops is a trusted leader in open-source database consulting, empowering organizations worldwide to design, optimize, and scale their MySQL and MariaDB environments. Our dedication to operational excellence and community-driven innovation aligns seamlessly with the MariaDB Foundation's mission to promote openness, adoption, and continuous advancement of MariaDB.

Nexedi is Europe's largest open-source software (OSS) publisher and creator of ERP5. At Nexedi, we design, develop and deploy enterprise solutions ranging from ERP to pure Decentralized Cloud and Industrial Big Data.

Nextcloud is the world's most popular privacy-focused collaboration platform. It is used by tens of thousands of private and public organizations and tens of millions of private individuals to stay in control of their sensitive data and ensure privacy compliance.

With Nextcloud, users can edit and share documents, chat and hold videoconferences, and manage emails, contacts and calendars via easy web and mobile apps. The open-source software has a modular design and can be extended with hundreds of apps. It runs in on premises in a private cloud or with a trusted provider.

Founded in 2016, Nextcloud is fully employee-owned and has grown organically ever since. Learn more at www.nextcloud.com.

Passbolt is the European open source platform for managing passwords, secrets, and privileged accesses. Built for security-conscious tech teams, it adapts to multiple use cases, from IT and DevOps workflows to organization-wide credential management. It supports secure collaboration with granular access controls, and can be self-hosted to meet data sovereignty and compliance needs. Today, more than 40,000 organizations — including governments, startups and regulated companies — use Passbolt to protect their most critical credentials while retaining transparency, control, and auditability.

ProxySQL is the leading proxy for MySQL and has recently focused on supporting more and more of MariaDB, both with the Proxy and with other open-source projects ProxySQL is stewarding, like dbdeployer and orchestrator.

QUAPE is a Singapore-based web hosting and IT solutions company providing high-performance hosting, dedicated servers, VPS, cybersecurity, and custom software development since 2006. With a strong focus on reliability, speed, and enterprise-grade infrastructure, QUAPE supports SMEs and large enterprises with modern, scalable, and secure digital solutions.

RAVATAR is a leading developer of interactive digital humans and real-time AI avatars, shaping what is increasingly envisioned as the emerging Face of AI. With a pioneering focus on humanizing artificial intelligence, the company bridges the gap between people and machines by making digital communication more natural, expressive, and intuitive. RAVATAR actively supports open-source communities and is committed to building transparent, collaborative, and people-centered AI.

Redgate offers end-to-end Database DevOps to help organizations streamline software development and get value from their data faster. We've specialized in database software for over 25 years.

Releem is a database performance management platform that delivers consistent database performance through continuous profiling, configuration tuning, and SQL query optimization. It streamlines database monitoring and optimization — all in one place.

Releem supports MariaDB, MySQL, Percona, and AWS Aurora, whether deployed on-premise (Linux, Docker, Kubernetes) or in cloud-managed environments like AWS RDS.

Founded in 2002, Rumahweb is one of Indonesia's leading web hosting providers. We offer a wide range of services, including shared hosting, VPS, domains, and cloud hosting. Supported by 24/7 professional technical assistance and a commitment to innovation, Rumahweb serves individuals, SMEs, and large enterprises.

Senticore, a leader in engineering and manufacturing applications, focuses on cutting-edge AI solutions, particularly for the aerospace and defense sectors, and powers critical systems worldwide. Senticore addresses these sectors' concerns with locally deployed LLMs. Their platform integrates PDFs related to manufacturing, maintenance, and inspections processes into the digital thread. MariaDB supports their data-intensive workloads, crucial for high performance, reliability, and security, and its Vector capabilities are particularly important to Senticore's AI development, enabling efficient storage and retrieval of LLM vector embeddings.
Senticore Technologies is renowned for pushing innovation in complex technical domains. Committed to engineering excellence and robust solutions for demanding environments, their platform meets advanced technical requirements.

Seravo is a Finland-based specialist in premium hosting and upkeep for WordPress and WooCommerce. Open source sits at the heart of its technology stack and its company culture, and MariaDB has been part of that story for many years. Seravo uses MariaDB as part of the infrastructure behind its WordPress hosting platform, alongside technologies including Linux, Nginx and Redis. The company has built its hosting environment specifically around the requirements of demanding WordPress sites, where database performance, stability and scalability can have a direct impact on the experience of users.

Solanica is the company behind OpenEverest, an open-source CNCF Sandbox platform for running a wide range of databases on Kubernetes, including MariaDB. Solanica provides enterprise support and a database-as-a-service platform built on OpenEverest, enabling organisations to operate highly available databases, storage and LLMs, with automated backups and point-in-time recovery, on their own infrastructure.

Tempesta Technologies develops Tempesta FW (https://github.com/tempesta-tech/tempesta), an open source hybrid of a web accelerator and a multi-layer firewall. It's tightly coupled with the Linux TCP/IP stack and employs cutting edge technologies to efficiently block DDoS and web attacks and provide outstanding web application performance in normal operation.

TidesDB is an open source, high-performance storage engine library built from first principles for modern hardware. Designed for developers, database vendors, and enterprises, it delivers full ACID compliance across five isolation levels – exceeding industry standards – with adaptive compaction, multi-column family transactions, and a clean C API that embeds anywhere. TideSQL brings TidesDB's transactional performance to MariaDB as a native plugin integration. TidesDB is community-driven, vendor-neutral, and built entirely in the open

Vettabase is a boutique database consulting company specialising in professional services, automation, and training for MariaDB and other database technologies. Vettabase brings together a team of internationally recognised database experts whose expertise enables them to support complex database setups, leveraging cutting-edge technologies and tools.

Virtuozzo provides virtualization and cloud platform solutions for service providers worldwide. Headquartered in Switzerland, Virtuozzo builds on over two decades of innovation in containerization and hyper-converged infrastructure, enabling cost-effective public, private and hybrid clouds.

Wikimedia movement is a global community of people, projects, and activities working together to create and share knowledge freely.

Wirekite is an enterprise data movement platform focused on high-performance extract, load, migration, and replication workflows. Its technology helps organisations move data across database systems and keep data fresh between operational systems, analytics platforms, and application environments.

Wolf Ltd. are the architects of the Active Intelligence Platform (AIP), a solution founded on the belief that software should not simply report on business challenges, but actively solve them. We recognised that the era of passive BI and fragile, fragmented systems was over. Wolf Ltd. engineered Intelligentwolf to be the singular, unifying layer that sits on top of any tech stack, giving leaders the unprecedented power to read data from and write data back to every system instantly. This commitment to delivering verifiable action, not just insight, is why global enterprises trust the AIP to accelerate their transformation and command their business outcomes and overtime eliminate multiple sources of software into just one platform.

Zencoder is a universal AI platform focused on integrating generative coding workflows into existing developer tools and infrastructure. Connect any CLI to any IDE, starting with Claude Code, Codex and Zen CLI, while leveraging Zencoder's proprietary enterprise-grade features like multi-repo intelligence. The platform supports on-premise, hybrid, or cloud deployment, with air-gapped and zero-VPC options to maintain enterprise security. Through modular "Zen Agents", Zencoder codifies team practices into shareable, autonomous workflows that continuously code, test, and deploy.

## Board

Below is a list of current MariaDB Foundation board members. See Governance for more details on how MariaDB Foundation is governed.

## Board Members

**Ex officio: Founding Directors**

**Sergei Golubchik**
Chief Architect MariaDB Server at MariaDB Corporation
Designated as *Developer Representative*

**Michael "Monty" Widenius**
Founder of MariaDB and MySQL
Designated as *Founder*

**Directors representing organisational board members**

**Amazon Web Services**

**Nanda Kaushik**
Director, Aurora at Amazon Web Services
LinkedIn

**DBS**

**Ashish Bhan**
Executive Director, DBS Bank
LinkedIn

**MariaDB**

**Rohit De Souza**
CEO, MariaDB plc

**NextCloud**

**Frank Karlitschek**
Founder & CEO of Nextcloud

**Virtuozzo**

**Kurt Daniel**
CEO, Virtuozzo

**Individual Directors**

**Kaj Arnö**
Executive Chairman

**Frédéric (lefred) Descamps**
Community Advocate

**Board member biographies**

**Kaj Arnö**
Executive Chairman

Kaj is a software industry generalist, having served as VP Professional Services, VP Engineering, CIO and VP Community Relations of MySQL AB prior to the acquisition by Sun Microsystems. At Sun, Kaj served as MySQL Ambassador to Sun and Sun VP of Database Community. Board member at Footbalance Systems Oy (Helsinki, Finland). Past founder, CEO and 14 year main entrepreneur of Polycon Ab (Finland).

Kaj is a co-founder of MariaDB Corporation Ab, and served on its Executive Team in several positions, most recently Chief Evangelist.

Kaj lives and works in **Munich, Germany**, and during summer often in **Nagu, Finland**. He is a citizen of both countries. Kaj holds a M.Sc. (Eng.) from Helsinki University of Technology (now Aalto University) and an MBA from Hanken School of Economics.

**Programming**-wise, Kaj started out on the TI-58 in the 1970s, followed by Basic and a bit of assembler on the ABC-80 and ABC-800, together with Michael “Monty” Widenius. Kaj took fondness to APL on mainframes, before settling on the 4GL Focus as the technical basis for his first company Polycon. After a Visual Basic period, a Delphi period and a brief PHP period, Kaj moved out of programming into management, only to realise in 2011 that Python is good for his mental well-being. His venture into geodata with Python even left some superficial traces on Github.

**Licensing**-wise, Kaj contributed to GPLv3 as co-chair of the industry Committee B, advising the FSF on GPLv3 in 2006-07, observing how Eben Moglen led the process towards industry consensus. In 2014, Kaj formalised the Business Source License BSLv1 with its originator Michael Widenius, and made it more mainstream into BSLv1.1 with the help of Bruce Perens and Heather Meeker.

**Language**-wise, Kaj is a native Swedish speaker. He also speaks German, English, Finnish and French, and has presented in a number of other languages, including Russian, Japanese, Chinese, and Estonian, mostly understanding what he is saying.

Kaj joined MariaDB Foundation as CEO on 1 February 2019.

**Email:** kaj@mariadb.org
**Zulip:** Kaj Arnö

**Sergei Golubchik**
Developer Representative, Chief Architect MariaDB at MariaDB Corporation

Sergei was a MySQL developer since 1998. From 1999 to 2009 in MySQL AB, Sun, then in Monty Program AB and MariaDB Corporation on MariaDB. During these years he has touched almost every part of the server. To list a few projects – fulltext search, XA, HANDLER, precision math library, parallel repair and bulk inserts in MyISAM, indexes in MERGE. Sergei is a primary architect of the plugin API and an author of the “MySQL 5.1 Plugin Development” book.

**Frank Karlitschek**
Founder & CEO of Nextcloud

Frank Karlitschek is a long time open source contributor and former board member of the KDE e.V. He founded Nextcloud in 2016 to create a fully open source and decentralized alternative to big centralized cloud companies. Frank was an invited expert at the W3C to help to create the ActivityPub standard. Frank has spoken at MIT, CERN, Harvard and ETH and keynoted many conferences. Frank is the founder and CEO of Nextcloud GmbH. He is also a fellow of Open Forum Europe and an advisor to the United Nations regarding Open Source. Frank won the European SFS Free Software Award 2023 and the Acteurs du Libre European Award 2023.
MariaDB is the recommended Database at Nextcloud and MariaDB and Nextcloud share the same values like Open Source, Data Protection and Community.

**Nanda Kaushik**
Director, Aurora at Amazon Web Services

Nanda Kaushik is Director of Engineering at AWS, responsible for Amazon Aurora MySQL and RDS MySQL. A seasoned technology executive with extensive database experience spanning Oracle, Sybase, SAP, and Amazon, he has provided technical and thought leadership across organizations of all sizes, building global teams and delivering enterprise-grade

cloud and on-premise software. His expertise spans relational database engines, streaming analytics, and machine learning.

**Kurt Daniel**
CEO, Virtuozzo

Kurt Daniel is CEO of Virtuozzo, with a track record as a five-time CEO and prior executive roles at MongoDB, Parallels, and Worklight. He is a two-time founder with earlier experience at Microsoft. Kurt serves as an independent board member and advisor across companies including Acronis, Constructor Group, and the MariaDB Foundation, as well as leading venture capital and private equity firms. His strengths span general management, strategy, product management, and business development, and he has contributed to fourteen exits, including four IPOs and ten acquisitions.

**Ashish Bhan**
Executive Director, DBS

Dynamic and results-driven Executive Director and Distinguished Engineer with a robust track record in leading cloud and data engineering initiatives. Adept at driving enterprise architecture transformation, leveraging Kubernetes, and optimizing big data, analytics, and AI/ML infrastructures. Proven expertise in automation, Site Reliability Engineering (SRE), DevSecOps practices, and AIOps, delivering scalable, secure, and efficient solutions across complex, high-performance environments.

**Steve Shaw**
Database Performance Engineer | Developer of HammerDB

Steve Shaw is a former open source database lead for Intel and lead developer of the open source database benchmarking tool HammerDB. With more than 20 years experience in commercial database he is also the author of 2 books on Oracle on Linux. He now focuses exclusively on ensuring that open source relational database runs best on Intel platforms.

**Rohit De Souza**
CEO MariaDB

Global Technology Executive, CEO, Board Member, Strategic Advisor – Adept at translating sophisticated corporate strategy, market and competitive insights into tactical business plans and practical commercial growth initiatives, in intensely competitive global technology markets, for tangible results

20+ years of experience directing commercial growth, streamlining operations, building high-performance teams, and increasing operational excellence across competitive international technology markets.

I recruit and establish productive cross-functional teams in diverse cultures, spanning complex environments, and technological change. I have an entrepreneurial mindset, and adept at designing successful business models for both emerging and mature markets and transforming commercial operations.

Have successfully taken companies in various stages of their lifecycle through growth, transformation, financing, M&A and negotiated successful exits for investors and teams.

**Michael “Monty” Widenius**
Founder of MariaDB and MySQL

The “spiritual father” of MariaDB, one of the original developers of MySQL, and a renowned advocate for the open source software movement. In addition to serving as CTO for the MariaDB Corporation, he is also a Founder and a board member of the MariaDB Foundation. He was a founder at SkySQL, and the CTO of MySQL AB until its sale to Sun Microsystems (now Oracle). Monty was also the founder of TCX DataKonsult AB, a Swedish data warehousing company. He is the co-author of the “MySQL Reference Manual” and was named Finnish Software Entrepreneur of the Year in 2003. In 2015, Monty was selected as one of the 100 most influential people in the Finnish IT market. Monty studied at Helsinki University of Technology and lives in Finland.

## Board Observers

**Barry Abrahamson**
CTO Automattic

**Espen Håkonsen**
Director Services Nordics, Crayon Group

**Jim Zemlin**
Executive Director at Linux Foundation

**Michal Schorm**
Senior Software Engineer at Red Hat

**Sean Peng**

**Serg Bell**

**Stanislav Protasov**
President and Chairman of the Executive Board of Constructor University / President of Constructor Knowledge

**Steve Shaw**
Database Performance Engineer | Developer of HammerDB

**Todd Boyd**
Senior Technical Staff Member at IBM

**Barry Abrahamson**

Community Representative, Systems Wrangler at Automattic

Barry started using MySQL v3.23 in 2003 while working at Rackspace in San Antonio, Texas. Since 2006 Barry has served as Chief Systems Wrangler at Automattic, the company behind WordPress.com and many other well known web services such as Akismet and Gravatar. He also serves as the infrastructure lead for the open source WordPress.org software project. Barry currently lives in Houston, Texas with his family and enjoys the outdoors, eating BBQ, building LEGO, and tinkering with home automation in his free time.

**Espen Håkonsen**
Director Services Nordics, Crayon Group

Espen has been CIO of Visma and Managing Director of Visma IT & Communications since September 2013, and a MariaDB board member since 2015.

**Jim Zemlin**

Community Representative, Systems Wrangler at Automattic

Jim Zemlin's career spans three of the largest technology trends to rise over the last decade: mobile computing, cloud computing, and open source software. Today, as executive director of The Linux Foundation, he uses this experience to accelerate innovation in technology through the use of open source and Linux.

At The Linux Foundation, Jim works with the world's largest technology companies, including IBM, Intel, Google, Samsung, Qualcomm, and others to help define the future of computing on the server, in the cloud, and on a variety of mobile computing devices. His work at the vendor-neutral Linux Foundation gives him a unique and aggregate perspective on the global technology industry.

Jim has been recognized for his insights on the changing economics of the technology industry, and he is a regular keynote speaker at industry events. He advises a variety of startups, including Splashtop, and sits on the boards of the Global Economic Symposium, Open Source For America, and Chines

**Michal Schorm**

Senior Software Engineer at Red Hat

Part of the Databases Team at Red Hat and based in the Czech Republic, Michal Schorm is a graduate of the Faculty of Information Technology at Brno University of Technology.

Since late 2016 he has maintained the MariaDB, MySQL and ODBC stacks for Fedora and Red Hat Enterprise Linux, covering more than 20 source packages that include servers, connectors, drivers and supporting tools. He is a Fedora Proven Packager, leads the @db-sig package group, and has authored 11 Fedora Change Proposals. These include the Fedora 40 MariaDB/MySQL repackaging and a system-wide improvement to RPM build-flag macros. He is also the upstream maintainer of xmlto and mysql-selinux.

**Serg Bell**

Entrepreneur, investor and speaker, the founder and chairman of the board of Constructor, formerly known as Schaffhausen Institute of Technology (SIT) and multiple global IT companies, including Acronis, a global data protection company, and was the senior founding partner of Runa Capital, a technology investment firm. He is also executive chairman of the board and chief architect of Parallels, Inc., a virtualization technology company, co-founder and chairman of the board of Acumatica, an enterprise resource planning software (ERP) company, and co-founder of QWave Capital.

**Stanislav Protasov**

President and Chairman of the Executive Board of Constructor University / President of Constructor Knowledge

President of Constructor University Bremen. He has more than 20 years of experience in global software development: from developing and designing system and application software to creating and developing globally remote engineering teams that effectively take part in the general software development process. He also co-founded Acronis in 2001 and currently

leads the company's operations. Stanislav holds a Ph.D in Computer Science from the Moscow Institute of Physics and Technology.

**Todd Boyd**
IBM

Todd Boyd has worked for IBM for over 30 years in various capacities; he started in ZSeries I/O performance before moving to the Power Systems performance team. He has lead the Competitive Analysis Technical Team (CATT) for the last 15 years which projects the performance capabilities of competitive systems and solutions. He now works on the Cognitive Systems offering team in conjunction with the performance and the ISV teams to drive the Power portfolio offerings. In this role he deals with many ISV's and acts as the IBM representative on the MariaDB Foundation Board.

## Team

**Anna Widenius**
CEO

**Alexander Morozov**
Media Production Team

**Daniel Black**
Chief innovation officer

**Faustin Lammler**
System and network engineer

**Frédéric (lefred) Descamps**
Community Advocate

**Georgi Kodinov**
Community Contributions Officer

**Jonathan (Jeb) Miller**
Benchmarking Enablement Lead

**Michael (Monty) Widenius**
Founder & CTO

**Kristian Nielsen**
Chief Architect Replication

**Razvan-Liviu Varzaru**
DevOps Engineer

Chief Development Officer

**Vlad Radu**

**Anna Widenius**
CEO

**Email:** anna@mariadb.org
**Zulip:** Anna Widenius

**Alexander Morozov**
Media Production Team

**Email:** morozov@mariadb.org

**Daniel Black**
Chief Innovation Officer

After a reasonable amount of time doing development and IT security work, Daniel landed a DBA Consultant job and loved it.

After writing a few too many bug fixes without a client to bill them to, he joined IBM to make MariaDB and MySQL scale on IBM POWER.

The love for the community brought him to MariaDB Foundation where he embraces the innovation of contributors and users to make MariaDB better for everyone.

**Email:** daniel@mariadb.org
**Zulip:** Daniel Black

**Faustin Lammler**
System and network engineer

Faustin is a French System and Network engineer; his skills go from BGP to Ansible passing by LaTeX.

Free software and open standard/format enthusiast, Faustin believes it is important that users are encouraged and able to share their knowledge freely.

At the MariaDB Foundation Faustin works on infrastructure, releases, mirrors, buildbot, installation and upgrade testing.

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**Zulip:** Faustin Lammler

**Frédéric -lefred- Descamps**
Community Advocate

“@lefred” has been consulting on Open Source and databases for 20+ years. After graduating in Management Information Technology, Frédéric started his career as a developer for an ERP under HPUX. He will then pursue a career in open-source by joining one of the first Belgian start-ups dedicated 100% to free projects around GNU/Linux. It was in 2011 that lefred joined Percona, one of the leading MySQL-based specialists. He joined to join the MySQL Community Team in 2016 as a MySQL Community Manager for EMEA & APAC. In 2026, lefred moved to a more open-source, MySQL-compatible, and innovative database: MariaDB, and joined the foundation. Frédéric is also a regular speaker at OpenSource Conferences. His blog, mostly dedicated to Open Source databases, is http://lefred.be

Fred is also the devoted father of three adorable daughters: Wilhelmine, Héloïse & Barbara.

**Email:** lefred@mariadb.org
**Zulip:** Frédéric -lefred- Descamps

**Georgi “Joro” Kodinov**
Community Contributions Officer

Joro has been working with databases for his entire technical carrier: both as a developer and as a user. He’s been working on the code-base since 2006, most recently leading a server development team focusing on SQL security and the client/server protocol. Joro loves interacting with the community: he’s delivered a number of talks to database conferences. He believes that engaging with the community is a very important task and is thrilled to be a champion for contributions by it.

**Email:** joro@mariadb.org
**Zulip:** Georgi Kodinov

**Jonathan (Jeb) Miller**
Benchmarking Enablement Lead

Jeb Miller has spent 26 years benchmarking database software—five years at PervasiveSQL (Btrieve) and over two decades with MySQL.

He built frameworks, established performance departments, created SOPs for handling performance tasks, and led teams ensuring developers had production-level service. His work included performance change automation farms and release testing, embedding benchmarking into the core of database development.

As Benchmarking Enablement Lead at the MariaDB Foundation, Jeb is building an open source benchmarking test automation framework. The framework integrates existing benchmarking tools into plugin test suites, providing an easier way to run and compare results without requiring deep tool knowledge. Driven by user-defined properties, it ensures benchmarks are reproducible, transparent, and contributor-friendly—allowing anyone to rerun the exact same tests and improve the ecosystem together.

**Email:** jeb@mariadb.org
**Zulip:** jeb

**Kristian Nielsen**
Chief Architect Replication

Kristian has been a MariaDB developer since the project was started in 2009. Before that he worked as a developer in MySQL Ab, working with the NDB storage engine after implementing the Pushbuild CI.

Kristian has done a lot of work on MariaDB replication, including designing and implementing Group Commit, Global Transaction ID, and Paralle Replication. Other work includes the non-blocking client API, InnoDB/XtraDB maintenance, Buildbot/releases, and lots of test case fixes.

Kristian's primary focus at the MariaDB Foundation is advancing the state of MariaDB replication in the server source code. Designing and implementing major new features focused on performance and stability; and reviewing replication code changes to ensure future code correctness, consistency and maintainability.

**Razvan-Liviu Varzaru**
DevOps Engineer

Razvan-Liviu Varzaru is responsible for maintaining buildbot.mariadb.org, the continuous integration framework used by MariaDB.
With several years of experience as a DevOps engineer and a background in Aerospace Engineering, Razvan-Liviu combines technical expertise with a dedication to quality code.
Outside of work, he enjoys playing music, bringing creativity and rhythm to both his personal and professional life.

**Vlad Radu**

Vlad is responsible for the development and maintenance of the MariaDB Server Ecosystem Hub, and administers and maintains the mariadb.org website. He also handles release publishing on the Foundation website and has contributed to the feedback plugin reporting system.

# Policies

## Certificate of Incorporation

The Certificate of Incorporation of MariaDB Foundation is available at https://mariadb.org/certificate.

## By-laws

The By-laws of MariaDB Foundation are available at https://mariadb.org/bylaws.

## Governance

The MariaDB Foundation uses technical and legal means to guarantee the technology used by the MariaDB Server community will continue to be open in every sense.

All relevant information can be found in the Governance Overview page sourced from the MariaDB/governance repository.

**Non-profit foundation**

The MariaDB Foundation is non-stock not-for-profit and incorporated in Delaware, USA. It is aiming at US 501(c)(3) status.

**Board of directors**

The foundation is legally controlled by the board. The board makes decisions on how the foundation can best serve the MariaDB Server community. The board does not make technical decisions.

See the current Board of Directors.

**Contributions**

- We have published a code of conduct for how we work in the open source environment. We expect from others what we expect from ourselves.
- All code we produce will by default be GPL (e.g. MariaDB) or BSD-new (e.g. all-purpose libraries).
- Any patches given to us for our project's source trees should be licensed under the MariaDB contributor agreement (MCA), BSD-new license, or public domain (in that order of preference). We require this to be sure we can use the code freely in MariaDB and other products. We also want to be able to contribute the code forward to other open source projects.
    - Log of MariaDB Contributions contains an audit trail of patches included into MariaDB and whether they were contributed under the MCA or BSD.

## Maintenance policy

**Long-term releases (LTS)**

A new long-term release (LTS) of MariaDB Server is announced yearly. Binaries for MariaDB Server are released for Community, Enterprise, and Extended long-term support levels. MariaDB Community LTS binaries are released for 3 years after the GA date on mariadb.org/download (and mariadb.com/downloads). [1] [2]

For organisations needing to upgrade to an enterprise version that is commercially supported, contact mariadb.com for enterprise binaries, including an extended release option maintained and supported for 5 and 8 years, respectively, after the GA date.

[1] Critical and security fixes will be provided in source code releases for 2 additional years beyond Community LTS binary release period.
[2] For releases up to MariaDB 11.4, the binaries are released for 5 years after the GA date on https://mariadb.org/download.

**Rolling releases**

The continuously updated rolling releases of MariaDB Server are announced on a quarterly basis. The frequent updates address vulnerabilities, fix bugs, and reflect the latest features of MariaDB. The Stable Update releases are tested both internally and through external testing programs. They correspond to the main GitHub branch at https://github.com/MariaDB/server.

**Current and past versions**

## MariaDB Server long-term release maintenance periods

| | | End of Life date for maintenance | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Release** | **GA release date** | **Community** | **Enterprise** | **Extended** |
| 12.3 | 28 May 2026 | 12 June 2029 | TBC | TBC |
| 11.8 | 4 Jun 2025 | 4 Jun 2028 | 22 Oct 2030 | 22 Oct 2033 |
| 11.4 | 29 May 2024 | 29 May 2029 | 16 Jan 2030 | 16 Jan 2033 |
| 10.11 | 16 Feb 2023 | 16 Feb 2028 | 16 Feb 2028 | 16 Feb 2028 |
| 10.6 | 6 Jul 2021 | 6 Jul 2026 | 23 Aug 2028 | 23 Aug 2029 |
| 10.5 | 24 Jun 2020 | 24 Jun 2025 | 16 Jul 2025 | 16 Jul 2025 |
| 10.4 | 18 Jun 2019 | 18 Jun 2024 | 18 Jun 2024 | 18 Jun 2024 |
| 10.3 | 25 May 2018 | 25 May 2023 | 25 May 2023 | 25 May 2023 |
| 10.2 | 23 May 2017 | 23 May 2022 | 23 May 2022 | 23 May 2022 |
| 10.1 | 17 Oct 2015 | 17 Oct 2020 | 17 Oct 2020 | 17 Oct 2020 |
| 10.0 | 31 Mar 2014 | 31 Mar 2019 | 31 Mar 2019 | 31 Mar 2019 |
| 5.5 | 11 Apr 2012 | 11 Apr 2020 | 11 Apr 2020 | 11 Apr 2020 |
| 5.3 | 29 Feb 2012 | 1 Mar 2017 | 1 Mar 2017 | 1 Mar 2017 |
| 5.2 | 10 Nov 2010 | 10 Nov 2015 | 10 Nov 2015 | 10 Nov 2015 |
| 5.1 | 1 Feb 2010 | 1 Feb 2015 | 1 Feb 2015 | 1 Feb 2015 |

- Community support
- Enterprise support
- Extended support
- End of life

## MariaDB Server rolling releases

| Release | Release date | Community EOL |
|---|---|---|
| 13.1 | Sep 2026 | Q1 2027 |

| Release | Release date | Community EOL |
|---|---|---|
| 13.0 | May 2026 | Q4 2026 |

These dates constitute the public policy of the MariaDB Foundation and are not legally binding. The software is released with the GPLv2 license as-is, without warranties.

MariaDB currently uses the following meanings for the three numbers a.b.c in the release numbering scheme. We reserve the right to adjust it in the future.
**a.** is the major version series (MariaDB 11 being the latest LTS series). Starting MariaDB 12, we expect “a” to grow yearly.
**b.** is the minor version, which indicates the level of functionality. The “b” number grows quarterly. For each major version series, the minor version with the largest “b” is the LTS branch of the series.
**c.** is the patch version, which indicates the level of maturity. The “c” number grows with each bug fix release, scheduled quarterly. For exceptional situations, there can be additional releases. No new features are added to subsequent patch versions.

**Compatibility**

**c.** Patch versions (e.g. 11.4.4) only fix security issues and bugs.
**b.** Minor version releases (e.g. 11.4) add functionality but maintain backwards-compatibility.
**a.** Major release series (e.g. 12) may make backwards-incompatible changes.

In all releases, including major releases, we always make sure that the `mariadb-upgrade` facility runs correctly and the database files from any older release can be upgraded, including releases of MySQL prior to MySQL 8.0.

## MariaDB Server GA release cadence 2025-2031

<table>
<tr><th></th><th colspan="4">2025</th><th colspan="4">2026</th><th colspan="4">2027</th><th colspan="4">2028</th><th colspan="4">2029</th><th colspan="4">2030</th><th colspan="4">2031</th></tr>
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| | 2025 | | | | 2026 | | | | 2027 | | | | 2028 | | | | 2029 | | | | 2030 | | | | 2031 | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Q1 | Q2 | Q3 | Q4 | Q1 | Q2 | Q3 | Q4 | Q1 | Q2 | Q3 | Q4 | Q1 | Q2 | Q3 | Q4 | Q1 | Q2 | Q3 | Q4 | Q1 | Q2 | Q3 | Q4 | Q1 | Q2 | Q3 | Q4 |
| 12.3 | LTS | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | |
| 12.2 | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | |
| 12.1 | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | |
| 12.0 | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | |
| 11.8 | LTS | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | |
| 11.7 | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | |
| 11.4 | LTS | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | |
| 10.11 | LTS | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | |
| 10.6 | LTS | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | |

- Community support
- Enterprise support
- Extended support

### Privacy policy

MariaDB Foundation strongly believes in privacy laws and adheres to the rules of GDPR. View our full privacy policy here.

### Security policy

MariaDB Foundation is committed to ensuring all security bugs are fixed within stable MariaDB Server versions. View our full security policy here.

## Other

### Logos and badges

The logo is available for use under the Creative Commons CC-BY-SA license.

- These marks identify the **MariaDB Foundation**. You may use them to refer to the Foundation and its activities — for example, to link to us, to indicate membership or sponsorship, or in articles, talks, and presentations about the Foundation.

- Use the files as provided. Don’t alter the proportions, colours, or elements. Where you need a single-colour or reversed version for dark backgrounds, use the variants we supply rather than recolouring it yourself.
- Don’t use the logo to suggest that the Foundation endorses, sponsors, or is affiliated with your product, project, or organisation unless we have agreed to that.
- Don’t use it to refer to other MariaDB or non-MariaDB entities, and don’t incorporate it into your own logo, product name, or branding.
- Give it clear space; don’t lock it up with other marks so they read as one combined mark.

Please click on the logos for the full-sized versions.

**For more variants (inverted PNG, SVG formats) please go to GitHub.**

MariaDB Foundation Logo. Horizontal orientation. For use over dark backgrounds. MariaDB Foundation Logo. Vertical orientation. For use over dark backgrounds. MariaDB Foundation Logo. Vertical orientation. MariaDB Foundation Logo. Horizontal orientation.
MariaDB Foundation Logo Black and white. Horizontal orientation. MariaDB Foundation Logo Black and white. Vertical orientation.

## Usage statistics

Beginning in October 2011, MariaDB Server included a new User Feedback plugin. When the plugin is activated (it is inactive by default), it can periodically upload configuration and usage information to mariadb.org.

The information gathered by the User Feedback plugin provides the MariaDB project with useful input in form of:

- which platforms and hardware MariaDB is run on
- an indication of the worldwide distribution of MariaDB
- the version and build numbers of MariaDB that are in use
- features that are used

The main purpose behind collecting this kind of information is to use it to steer engineering and community development of MariaDB Server in the right directions. The information is used to continuously improve the product.

The User Feedback plugin gathers only non-sensitive information such as:

- processor type, speed, amount of processors/cores
- operating system, distribution, and kernel information
- storage engines that are in use
- list of loaded plugins
- and other similar data

The User Feedback plugin will never send any personal or sensitive information such as user names, database names or contents, or anything that would enable the tracking of the user.

The complete manual of the User Feedback plugin, including instructions for how to see what *exactly* is being sent, can be found on the User Feedback plugin page of the MariaDB Knowledgebase.

## Statistics Dashboard